BIOLOGICAL/PHYSICAL FALSE BELIEF #53 · APPEARANCE AND BODY IMAGE

“People are always staring and judging me.”

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Where it often comes from

Self-consciousness can make us feel watched, especially after trauma, bullying, or visible differences. Often others are absorbed in their own concerns, but the feeling of being watched is vivid.

What Scripture teaches

“O LORD, You have searched me and known me.” Psalm 139 shows that we are always seen by God, and seen with love. “The fear of man is a snare, but whoever trusts in the LORD is set securely on high.” People notice less than we fear, and when they do stare, it often reflects curiosity or their own discomfort. God’s view of you is kind: “He will quiet you with His love.”

> *“The fear of man is a snare, but whoever trusts in the LORD is set securely on high”* (Proverbs 29:25).

Also see

> “O LORD, You have searched me and known me” (Psalm 139:1).

> “The LORD your God is among you; He is mighty to save. He will rejoice over you with gladness; He will quiet you with His love; He will rejoice over you with singing” (Zephaniah 3:17).

> “Am I now seeking the approval of men, or of God? Or am I striving to please men? If I were still trying to please men, I would not be a servant of Christ” (Galatians 1:10).

> “When I am afraid, I put my trust in You. In God, whose word I praise— in God I trust. I will not be afraid. What can man do to me?” (Psalm 56:3–4).

Common self-statements

- Everyone is looking at me.
- They are all judging.
- I cannot go anywhere without being stared at.
- I feel exposed.
- I must hide.
- They are talking about me.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing people either ignore me or judge me.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that people will stare.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling exposed and concluding that I am being judged.
- Mind reading: Calling myself the center of attention.

Challenging questions

- How often do I truly notice others’ appearance?
- What evidence do I have that people are judging?

- What do I do to avoid being seen, and what does it cost?
- What does God see when He looks at me?
- What would a small experiment look like, such as going out for ten minutes?
- Who can go with me?

Truth summary

> People notice me less than I fear, and God's gaze on me is loving. I can step out in small steps, with trusted company, and let His acceptance steady me.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Fear
- Anxiety/Worry
- Pride
- Self-Esteem, Low
- Trust

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Pride

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

My Plan for Replacing "People are always staring and judging me"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"People are always staring and judging me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ How often do I truly notice others' appearance?
- ☐ What evidence do I have that people are judging?
- ☐ What do I do to avoid being seen, and what does it cost?
- ☐ What does God see when He looks at me?
- ☐ What would a small experiment look like, such as going out for ten minutes?
- ☐ Who can go with me?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ The fear of man is a snare.
- ☐ The Lord knows and loves me.
- ☐ He quiets me with His love.
- ☐ I can step out gently.
- ☐ Most people are focused on themselves.
- ☐ I can trust the Lord.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Proverbs 29:25**
  "The fear of man is a snare, but whoever trusts in the LORD is set securely on high."
- ☐ **Psalm 139:1**
  "O LORD, You have searched me and known me."
- ☐ **Zephaniah 3:17**
  "The LORD your God is among you; He is mighty to save. He will rejoice over you with gladness; He will quiet you with His love; He will rejoice over you with singing."

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] Stepping out: Each week, note one outing and what actually happened.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Proverbs 29:25 becomes: "Sarah can write: "The Lord quiets me with His love.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Fear" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- [ ] Test the thought. Count actual stares during an outing.
- [ ] Go with someone. Take a trusted friend.
- [ ] Shorten and repeat. Build up gradually.
- [ ] Pray Psalm 56:3–4. Say it before going out.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "People are always staring and judging me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Stepping out
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~People are always staring and judging me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I feel watched. Quiet me with Your love, and give me courage to live among people without fear. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.